

TELOS PATHWAYS · AI PHILOSOPHY

AI Manifesto

Read widely, think rigorously, evaluate critically.

THE PROBLEM

Rapid advancements in AI capabilities raise a major question for young people today: why should I bother learning anything if AI can do my schoolwork for me? Students with this mindset become dependent on AI tools to perform tasks that were considered non-negotiable just a few years ago: many are reading summaries instead of books, generating automated essays from bullet points rather than writing fluently, relying on translation software rather than learning languages, and bypassing other challenging, rewarding, and essential aspects of learning. Blind reliance on these shortcuts weakens our discipline, concentration and mental flexibility. Most importantly, it erodes our sense of purpose.

OUR SOLUTION

Our pathways are designed to cultivate the focus and perseverance students need to resist AI dependency and engage deeply with ideas. The Silicon Valley saying goes, “move fast and break things.” We take a different approach: read widely, think rigorously, evaluate critically, and find genuine intellectual purpose. AI tools may perform certain academic tasks faster and more accurately than we can, but they cannot inspire the independence, dignity, or confidence that arise from real problem-solving and analytical thinking.

Human intelligence isn't obsolete in an AI-powered world; the thresholds for what constitutes it have merely risen. The AI revolution will undoubtedly render some jobs and skills redundant, but it will also create countless new ones. While the future is uncertain, one thing is clear: anyone capable of independent reasoning, debating, and forming original judgements is inherently better equipped to face the future of education and work. Our pathways foster these skills and restore a sense of purpose to your academic journey.

OUR APPROACH TO AI RESTS ON THREE PILLARS

01 Reading at all costs

Reading must never be outsourced to AI. Relying on summaries in place of original texts sacrifices our genuine intellectual understanding and has serious cognitive implications. Reading deeply and widely forces us to persevere through difficult passages, make connections between ideas, form original interpretations, and develop many other crucial skills. In doing so, we strengthen our attention span, memory, reasoning, creativity, and metacognitive awareness, all of which are essential to our neurological health and academic and professional pursuits.

Our Telos Pathways tutors pursued PhD research because we read widely and fell in love with the ideas we encountered along the way. We hope to inspire our students to find the same passion and purpose in their academic work.

02 Deploying AI critically and responsibly

We understand that AI is here to stay and can be leveraged constructively. We coach our students to treat AI tools as competent research assistants that can produce revision schedules, generate practice exam questions, organise notes, and perform other tasks that elevate their productivity. If students use AI to generate feedback on their work, they should do so interactively, prompting these models to provide explanations of errors, suggestions for improvement, and probing questions rather than simply ghostwriting alternative answers. The key is for AI to enhance rather than replace our human critical thinking capacities.

03 Understanding the AI revolution and the future of academic research

We are equally determined to prepare our students for the future of learning, academic research, and work in an AI-powered world. In our tutorials, we consider ethical and methodological questions surrounding AI's applications across different fields. For instance, could algorithmic analysis of social media data redefine sociological studies on public opinion and collective behaviour? Is translation software rendering linguists and translators redundant? How do debates surrounding AI's consciousness and moral judgement inform philosophical enquiry? How could AI-generated art and music complicate long-standing debates in aesthetics and cultural theory about authorship and originality? Engaging with these questions gives students the perspective and preparedness to approach an AI-powered future with their human intelligence and critical

thinking skills intact.